

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

For subscription queries, call the help desk at 022-27629191/9200, fax 022-27629164, or send an e-mail to help@jasubhai.com

Inbox

Dear Akash

Delhi is not the heart of India; it is Bombay—to use the name we know and love! OK, I was just kidding... getting serious, you're right in saying about piracy that though a seemingly plausible way out would be to lower prices, it is not possible for the big companies. And as for the companies not knowing these facts, our insight regarding this—rather, Agent 001's insight—has been published in an earlier issue. It's called, simply, *Is Piracy Good?* Do take a read.

Open source software is a good way to go, and you've probably noticed how much we focus on such software these days.

— Executive Editor

Disgruntled, And Rightfully

I have received one CD with a plastic protection sheet tightly fixed to the CD. After removing the plastic protection sheet (which is normally there in any CD box at the bottom), I inserted the CD in the drive and it was not recognised. I have already sent you a message in this regard.

The customer service does not give a reply whether it is for subscription renewal or for the status of subscription cheque or for a missing magazine or for any subscription scheme.

Even if the subscriber receives a reply, it will contain a message saying that every day they receive hundreds / thousands / lakhs / billions of messages.

As far as I know, the subscriber need not worry about the volume of messages received by a magazine every day; the magazine has to take measures to handle it. I now hope I will receive a reply for replacement of the damaged July 2007 CD.

A M Sameeullah

Dear Mr Sameeullah,

I agree: replying to your mails is our responsibility—hence, even if late, we need to reply them. I am personally arranging to send you a working July CD.

Please bear with us for a week on this. Thanks for writing to us and sharing your frank opinion.

— Executive Editor

Computers Or Cleavage?

Being a mechanical engineer, my only touch with technology is through *Digit*, to which I'm subscribed since the past few years. I've been wanting to mail *Digit* from quite some time now, but one thing or the other came up. I bought my cell and a new PC recently based on your suggestions. But the July edition just made me sit and type.

I've been used to seeing *Digit* as a hardcore technology magazine with no-nonsense stuff and no distractions; needless to say, the cover left me with a pleasant feeling at the same time surprising me. I know it's not the first time you have a woman on your cover, but this time it looked more like a film magazine. I'm used to seeing the cleavages of hardware that you normally show so generously, but I just wondered why on earth would a technology magazine have such a picture on its cover.

What was she posing with? Laptop? Cell phone? ...Let me check the cover of the issue again.

Navin D'Cunha
Thane

Dear Navin,

I'll respond to your comments about the cover.

First, being a hard-core tech magazine does not preclude a cover of the type you're talking about. One might be an alpha-geek or gamer, and he might still wear a plain yellow shirt—he doesn't necessarily wear a T-shirt with a motherboard on it (which he could), or a *Quake* logo. Second, it's not about cleavage. It's the particular dress the model was wearing. That dress is casual, which brings out the “casual, carefree computing” kind of theme we wanted to bring out for our laptop tests. After all, people use laptops while in bed, don't they—and that's something they can't do without Desktops.

About the fact that it was a woman on the cover, it adds to the human element. That might sound like a truism, but I hope you get what I mean. Yes, if you're saying “Why a woman and not a man,” look across our issues—you'll find plenty of men on our covers as well. Finally, I'd like to say that I'm not an expert on cover design—I leave that to the expert cover design team.

I'm sure several readers will echo your thoughts, and this open letter is addressed to all of them. Thanks for writing in—even if just with a minor concern!

— Executive Editor

ERRATA

In Mp3 player test article (June 2007), on page number 176-177, the Digit Best Buy Gold and Best Buy Silver Logos were misplaced. The correct placement should have been, Gold logo for iAudio's Cowon D2 and Silver logo on Sansa's E260 as stated correctly in the article. Inconvenience to our patrons is regretted.

Archi-tech-ture!

Dear Digitizers

I am an architect (at least that's what my university certificate says!). Maybe I was amongst the first few CAD users in college. Since then, I am more recognised as computer-savvy than as an architect. I am a regular subscriber to *Digit* since the last three years. I have no other option than keeping myself updated when it comes to technology, because friends hardly talk to me about anything in architecture, and rather, they would love to seek my advice on buying a good laptop, upgrading their existing graphics card, or at times the comparative analysis between AMD and Intel processors.

The institute where I am appointed as a faculty (architectural computing and design fundamentals) decided to go for Linux rather than Windows. I took up the challenge with a smile; I already had a handy book on Linux and open source software with me, which gave me many insights on Linux and open source software (don't tell my boss... he is under the impression that I have done a lot of research on Linux, and now I am expecting a raise!).

I learnt a lot from either *Digit* or the Internet without having to go for any formal education in graphic and Web design. Point is, technology has reached all the offices, may it be an architect, CA, lawyer, doctor, or stock broker for example. Can *Digit* come up with specialised issues on “technology for particular professions,” for example, *Software for Architects*.

When it comes to architecture, now there is BIM, estimation software, rendering software, software for checking sustainability issues, construction management for architects, and what not. *Digit* can even focus on architecture-specific hardware requirements.

Somebody has correctly put it: “Computers are not about computing any more, they are about living.”

Ar. Rajesh Advani

Dear Mr Advani

It is now knowledgeable people like you that we're trying to create; you're the best example of what *Digit's* aim is. To enrich someone's tech knowledge and awareness, to help him or her put it to good use, and to enable him to stand out from the crowd.

Many thanks for your e-mail—it has raised my spirits for the day!

— Executive Editor

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH